

Security Controls

The CIS Security Controls can complement any governance and security framework to provide more prescriptive actions any organization can take to improve their security posture. These 18 controls cover a wide array of protections and strategies. The table below shares a description and safeguard type of a few of these critical controls:

CIS Critical Security Control	Description	Safeguard Type (Administrative, Physical or Technical)
#1 - Inventory and Control of Enterprise Assets (example)	Actively manage all enterprise assets connected to the infrastructure physically, virtually, remotely, and those within cloud environments, to accurately know the totality of assets that need to be monitored and protected within the enterprise	Administrative
#5 – Account Management	Use processes and tools to assign and manage authorization to credentials for user accounts, including administrator accounts, as well as service accounts, to enterprise assets and software.	Administrative/ Technical
#6 – Access Control Management	Use processes and tools to create, assign, manage, and revoke access credentials and privileges for user, administrator, and service accounts for enterprise assets and software.	Physical/Technical
#7 – Continuous Vulnerability Management	Develop a plan to continuously assess and track vulnerabilities on all enterprise assets within the enterprise’s infrastructure, in order to remediate, and minimize, the window of opportunity for attackers. Monitor public and private industry sources for	Administrative/ Physical/Technical

	new threat and vulnerability information.	
#14 – Security Awareness & Skills Training	Establish and maintain a security awareness program to influence behavior among the workforce to be security conscious and properly skilled to reduce cybersecurity risks to the enterprise.	Administrative
#17 – Incident Response Management	Establish a program to develop and maintain an incident response capability (e.g., policies, plans, procedures, defined roles, training, and communications) to prepare, detect, and quickly respond to an attack.	Administrative/ Technical

Sources

Center for Internet Security. “The 18 CIS Controls.” CIS, 2024,
<https://www.cisecurity.org/controls/cis-controls-list>

Siddiqui, Laiba. “CIS Critical Security Controls 101: Everything to Know about the 18 Controls.” Splunk-Blogs, 11 Oct. 2024, http://www.splunk.com/en_us/blog/learn/cis-critical-security-controls.html